

NOVELISTIC SCREENPLAY

# POKÉMON NOCTURNE

## EPISODE 11

### *God's Cruel Wisdom*

Author

**Adelbert Vervloet**

*Working compilation*

Status · draft · pass 1/3 recorded · EN-GB apparatus

| Format          | Novelistic screenplay · EN anchors             |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Target duration | To be set — corpus $\approx$ 90 min read aloud |
| Scenes          | 15                                             |
| Version         | 2026-09-24 · EN-GB dossier after P1            |

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## Episode sheet

**Series** Pokémon Nocturne

**Episode** 11 — God's Cruel Wisdom

**Author** Adelbert Vervloet

### Logline

Kanto in spring. The Safari closed. Stands more hideous than Garchomp. A cénacle promises the death of NPCs. Green refuses that anyone should surpass Red. Oak names the Coyote and his own grace. Mewtwo is already there.

### Place in the arc

**Due:** the Red task; Dex; the softening; the spectre; Giovanni as bait.

**Paid:** virgin soil gone; gregarious predators; Lightworkers exposed; Green / Mt. Silver; cruel wisdom named.

**Open:** Oak's controversial favour; Mewtwo; Red still cloistered.

### Characters — this episode only

| Name                       | Function here                           |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Gold/Richter · Chris/Maria | Flight; arena; cénacle; Pallet          |
| Blaine / Green             | De-escalation; grace; badge             |
| The Psychic of the cénacle | Starseeds; Solar Flash; NPCs            |
| Misty / Silver             | Johto; the foreign homeland             |
| Oak                        | Imprecation; Coyote; grace              |
| Mewtwo                     | Just a Myth — already there             |
| Ace Trainer / Ranger       | Garchomp / Metagross — the stands watch |

### Places (EN anchors)

Cinnabar Island · Safari Zone (Fuchsia) · Vermilion (temporary arena, inn) · Saffron (cénacle) · Celadon · Viridian · Pallet Town (Oak's Lab).

### Technical notes — outside the scenes

| Heading       | Note                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cénacle       | Lightworkers / Starseeds / Solar Flash / Great Shift / Timeline Split. The Psychic designates supreme predators (5D) in order to do nothing. Gold reads the cult, not the faith. |
| Just a Myth   | A cue in the Castlevania: Nocturne OST, not truly used as such in the series. Title kept in English.                                                                             |
| Virgin soil   | Turgenev calque (Terres vierges). Not untouched / uncharted. Hold in the title and in Chris/Maria's line at the locked gate.                                                     |
| Imprecation   | Four sites in this episode (Green; Oak ×3). Not curse. Axis of the episode and of Episode 01.                                                                                    |
| Blaine's cane | Walking stick / cane. Not the hunting crop.                                                                                                                                      |

|         |                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| P1 gels | Antecedents, not background. Swords Dance. passable → ordinary. Seadra = she/her. Garchomp / Metagross = it/its. Mewtwo = he (speaking presence), to be frozen once. |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Screen durations (excluding titles)

Virgin soil 55–65 s. Predators 2 min 15–40. Redress 2 min 30–40. The foreign homeland 4 min 00–4 min 40. Melancholic bearing 4 min 20–4 min 50. If the future 5 min 20–5 min 50. Outcome of the new generation 3 min 40–4 min 10. Grace is the decision 4 min 20–4 min 50. God's Cruel Wisdom 6 min 30–7 min 20.

### BGM index — pieces (Nocturne OST)

| Scene                                  | Piece              | Range                                                 |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| De-escalation for the Antecedents      | Rebellion          | entry · 00:17 · 00:31 · ~00:47 · ~00:55 · 01:04–01:12 |
| The Disappearance of Virgin Soil       | Could Not Be Caged | 00:00–00:30 or 00:42                                  |
| The Gregarious Predators               | Eclipse            | 00:45–                                                |
| Psychological Security / inn           | My Sister          | 00:00–00:30                                           |
| Aristocracy and Predators, Alternating | Reborn             | entry                                                 |
| Aristocracy and Predators, Alternating | Work of the Devil  | after the question                                    |
| Grace Is the Decision                  | Too Heavy          | entry                                                 |
| Just a Myth                            | She Who Mauls      | 02:07 · 02:41 · 02:54 → end                           |

### BGM index — traces

*Address only.*

| Scene                               | BGM                  |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------|
| The Gregarious Predators            | EP02 S01 06:30–07:28 |
| Psychological Security              | EP01 S02 15:12–15:54 |
| Belated Redress for Others          | EP03 S02 16:50–17:30 |
| The Debt for the New Outfit / Grace | EP01 S02 04:30–05:40 |
| Grace Is the Decision               | EP02 S02 15:20–16:20 |
| God's Cruel Wisdom                  | EP06 S01 10:00–10:37 |
| God's Cruel Wisdom                  | EP01 S02 25:40–27:00 |
| God's Cruel Wisdom                  | EP07 S01 05:36–08:06 |
| God's Cruel Wisdom                  | EP03 S02 25:00–26:30 |

### Order of scenes

1. De-escalation for the Antecedents
2. The Disappearance of Virgin Soil

3. The Gregarious Predators
4. Psychological Security
5. Aristocracy and Predators in Alternation
6. Belated Redress for Others
7. The Foreign Homeland
8. The Rhetorical Evasion of the Law
9. The Melancholic Bearing toward Johto
10. The Debt for the New Outfit
11. If the Future Could Have Been Better More Easily
12. The Outcome of the New Generation
13. Grace Is the Decision
14. God's Cruel Wisdom
15. Just a Myth

*The scenes are inserted here. The close follows the body.*

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## Scene — De-escalation for the Antecedents

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*Cinnabar Island. Spring twilight.*

### **BGM ‘Rebellion’**

The ruins were still smouldering. No flames. Just low, grey smoke rising in patches like slow breaths. The ground remained warm beneath their feet. The air smelled of warm sulphur and damp ash.

### **BGM “Rebellion” 00:17–**

Blaine leaned on his walking stick, his gaze fixed on what had once been his town. He spoke without turning round.

‘I didn’t expect the boy who’d beaten me with such presumption... to end up softening toward the disaster that was my own city.’

Green remained silent for a moment. A very brief, joyless laugh escaped him.

“Sorry for growing up. I should have stayed the arrogant one, is that it?”

Blaine tilted his head slightly. His sunglasses slipped a millimetre. A glimpse of his eyes appeared — tired, but clear.

### **BGM ‘Rebellion’ 00:31**

“It’s just a de-escalation between us. But... it’s not a bad thing to be glad one day that you were defeated.”

He paused. Smoke drifted between them.

“It’s part of the reversal.”

Green did not reply. His gaze had drifted further away, towards the sea.

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### **BGM “Rebellion” around 00:47**

Out at sea, a silhouette stood out against the twilight sky. Gold/Richter was gliding in, one hand clasped around Fearow’s talons. They weren’t straining. They were catching the wind from the side, letting it carry them, conserving every wingbeat. The movement was slow, precise, almost silent. Like someone who already knows the cost of wasted effort.

Green watched him draw near. He said nothing at first. He simply observed the way the boy and the bird descended, unhurriedly, making use of whatever the wind was willing to give them.

### **BGM ‘Rebellion’ at around 00:55**

In a very low voice, almost to himself, Green murmured:

‘Let’s hope the new generation won’t have to pay the same price as us.’

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### **BGM ‘Rebellion’ 01:04 – 01:12**

Gold/Richter and Fearow did not land. They flew past, still high up, and continued towards the interior of the island, gradually fading into the orange and grey light of twilight.

In the foreground, Blaine and Green remained side by side, closer than they had been for a long time. Behind them, smoke was still rising from the ruins. Further away, growing smaller and smaller, Fearow's flight traced a clear, calm line across the spring sky.

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## **End of scene**

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## **Scene —The Disappearance of Virgin Soil**

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*The vicinity of the Safari Zone, Fuchsia City. Spring daylight.*

**BGM 'Could Not Be Caged' 00:00–00:30 or 00:42**

The screen slowly zoomed in on Fuchsia City. The rooftops were pristine. The streets, orderly. Then the camera glided towards the northern edge, where the city came to an abrupt end.

The Safari Zone.

The gates were closed. Behind them, the ponds had shrunk. The water stood still, brown, almost non-existent in places. Dead leaves from the previous autumn lay in dry piles against the fences. The mud had dried into grey patches. A smell of dust and withered vegetation hung in the air, despite it being spring.

Chris/Maria stood before the main entrance. She had not moved for some time. Her pale eyes were fixed on the chain and padlock, yet she did not truly see them.

Two residents approached, somewhat hesitantly.

'Are you... a stranger?'

She barely turned her face away.

"...Yes."

Her voice was flat. Disappointed, but without anger.

The man made a vague gesture towards the gate.

"The place is locked up. The boss has gone abroad. He's been away for a while now."

Chris/Maria tilted her head slightly.

"Thank you. I know that... I'd simply been given the wrong information."

They looked at her for another second, feeling uncomfortable at her stillness, then walked away.

She was left alone.

The wind blew a few dry leaves against the metal of the gate. Chris/Maria did not move. Her fingers slowly closed around the strap of her bag.

In a very low voice, almost without opening her mouth:

'I don't know... whether I've just missed my chance... or whether it means that even here... there's no virgin soil left.'

She stared at the locked door once more. The spring sunshine illuminated the rusty gates and the stagnant ponds behind them. She didn't leave straight away.

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## **End of scene**

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## **Scene — The Gregarious Predators**

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*Temporary arena. Vermilion City. A spring evening.*

### **BGM 'EP02 S01 06:30–07:28'**

The sea lapped gently against the quays. At this hour, Vermilion still retained a peaceful air. Then the camera pulled away from the harbour lights to zoom in on a temporary metal structure, erected on a wasteland. Spotlights that were too bright. A smell of hot oil and dust. Inside, the air was already stifling.

The arena was nothing more than a circle of movable barriers and removable seating. Yet spectators were crowding in. Faces from Kanto. Others, more exotic. All were looking in the same direction, with an intensity that was too fixed, too silent.

In the centre, two Trainers had taken their places.

On the left, an Ace Trainer with a posture that was too upright, too confident. Before him, a massive Garchomp, head bowed, its dorsal fins cutting through the light. On the right, a Pokémon Ranger with an almost fervent gaze. His Metagross waited, imposing, its red eyes ablaze.

A few murmurs rippled through the stands.

"That really is a Garchomp..." "And the other one... Metagross. You hardly ever see them here."

The voices were low, but the anticipation was anything but. Glances lingered too long on the two Pokémon. Jaws clenched. Breaths grew shallower.

Chris/Maria and Gold/Richter sat in the third row, slightly off to one side. No one paid them any attention.

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### **BGM 'Eclipse' 00:45–**

The Ranger raised his hand.

"Metagross, Bullet Punch!"

The voice sounded too confident. Almost theatrical. Metagross lunged forward immediately, without the slightest hesitation, as if it had been waiting for nothing but that command. The movement was sudden, direct, a little rough.

Garchomp slid to the side. Just enough. The attack merely grazed the air.

The Ace Trainer gave a very brief flicker of irritation.

“Fire Fang.”

Garchomp only acted after the command was given. He turned round and bit down. Its fangs flared too late, but with enough force to make Metagross take a heavy step back. The sound of the impact was dull and unpleasant.

“Back off!”

Metagross obeyed immediately, almost too obediently.

The Ace Trainer smiled faintly.

“Dragon Rush.”

Garchomp leapt into the air and came crashing down like a sledgehammer. It was not elegant; it was a way of pinning the opponent to the ground. Metagross could not dodge it. It took the full force of the blow and sank slightly into the clay.

“Earthquake.”

Garchomp struck the ground. The shockwave rippled out. Several spectators lost their balance for a moment. Hands clung to the barriers.

The Ranger almost shouted:

“Us too! Earthquake!”

Metagross mimicked the move. But the earthquake it produced was weaker, more defensive. It absorbed some of the impact, nothing more.

When the dust settled, Metagross was still standing, though its legs trembled. Garchomp, on the other hand, seemed barely affected.

The Ace Trainer spoke with cruel simplicity:

“You might as well give up.”

The Ranger clenched his fists.

“Are you mocking me? No matter the situation... I trust my partner!”

He said this as if it were a sacred truth. As if those words could still make a difference.

Metagross straightened up immediately, as if galvanised by the words. A loyalty that was too swift, almost mechanical. It wasn't out of the fight yet, but everyone could see he wouldn't last another clean exchange.

In the stands, the silence had turned into something else. Eyes gleaming. Mouths slightly agape. A quiet, almost animalistic eagerness. Some were clenching their fists so tightly that their knuckles had turned white. Others were leaning forward, unable to blink.

Chris/Maria felt something tighten in her throat. She looked around her. Then she looked at Garchomp.

The Ace Trainer raised his hand one last time.

“Sword Dance.”

The tone left no room for discussion. It was a way of saying the match was over.

Garchomp began to spin round and round. The air around him began to vibrate. Its posture was no longer that of a fighter. It was that of a predator who no longer needed to rush.

The spectators had not taken their eyes off the centre of the arena. Their faces, in the harsh white light, looked frozen and ravenous.

More hideous, at that moment, than many a monster.

Chris/Maria stood up. She said nothing. She simply let her ticket fall onto the seat and walked down the aisle without looking back.

Gold/Richter lingered for another second. His eyes shifted from the spectators to Garchomp, then to Metagross, who was still trying to hold out. He stood up in turn and followed Chris/Maria.

Behind them, no one noticed they had left.

On the field, Garchomp was finishing its Sword Dance. Slowly. Almost with relish. All eyes remained fixed on Garchomp as it completed its dance. The Pokémon didn't look as though it was preparing for a battle. It looked as though it was preparing to eat.

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## **End of scene**

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## **Scene — Psychological Security**

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### **Vermilion City – a spring evening**

#### **BGM 'EP01S02 15:12–15:54'**

The streets still smelled of warm tarmac and, in the distance, the sea. The streetlamps cast a yellow, slightly dingy light onto the pavements. There were few passers-by. A light breeze would occasionally lift bits of paper up against the gutters.

Chris/Maria and Gold/Richter walked side by side. Not leaning against one another. Just close enough to remain within the same safety perimeter. The silence between them was thick and awkward, as if it still carried the scent of the arena.

Chris/Maria's shoulders were slightly hunched. Her gaze remained lowered. Gold/Richter, for his part, was discreetly scanning the street corners, more out of habit than any real fear.

After a long moment, he spoke in a low voice:

"Sorry... about tonight."

Chris/Maria didn't speak straight away. When she replied, it was with a weary, almost generous sarcasm:

"You couldn't have known it would be like this."

Gold/Richter paused. His eyes remained fixed straight ahead.

"What's repulsive... is having to admit they were right. Apollo. Athena. Even Lance. In part."

Not about everything. But about what people are capable of watching without batting an eyelid... when they're told it's a fight."

He added, even more quietly:

"Gregarious predators. Nothing more."

Chris/Maria barely slowed her pace. Her voice came out hoarse, almost as if she were surprised by it herself:

"We call it a fight... So we watch. And we tell ourselves that the bond, the trust... are enough to justify everything. I'd imagined something more grandiose. More monstrous. Not something so... passable. And so obscene."

They came within sight of the inn. A simple, clean, three-star building. Good enough for a quiet stay.

Gold/Richter paused for a moment in front of the door. He spoke without looking at her, with that tender awkwardness that sometimes came over him:

**BGM: 'My Sister' 00:00–00:30**

"You don't have to take the same room. If you need more space... there's no need to skimp on that."

A slight flush crept up to his cheekbones, quite by accident.

Chris/Maria finally looked up at him. Her tone was teasing, but without any real barbs:

'We're not going to waste money on that. And you're not the sort to cross the line.'

A pause. Then, more seriously:

"Your thing is the gyms. Do you really have to come with me everywhere?"

Gold/Richter simply replied:

"In Johto, I didn't worry about it. In Kanto... security is not merely physical."

Chris/Maria did not reply. She stared at the front of the inn for a moment, then nodded faintly, as if accepting something she did not feel like discussing tonight.

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**End of scene**

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**Scene — Aristocracy and Predators in Alternation**

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**Saffron City – a spring evening**

The metropolis never really went to sleep. Even at this hour, the neon signs cast a cold, bluish light onto the still-busy pavements. The air smelled of warm concrete, electricity and, at times, a hint of dampness rising from the underground canals.

Chris/Maria and Gold/Richter walked on without speaking. They had already realised, several streets back, that they had come to the wrong place. This was not the spiritualism Will had spoken of.

The door to the *cenacle* swung open onto a thick gloom. Inside, the air was heavier, laden with incense and artificial heat. Geometric symbols ran along the walls. At the far end of the room, very

blurred, almost lost in the dim light, a four-legged figure with overly sharp edges was barely visible — Arceus, or what they had made of him. A god of a higher dimension, reduced to a discreet projection.

They sat at the back.

### **BGM 'Reborn'**

The Psychic was already standing. His voice was measured, slow, slightly impassioned:

'This world... dense, heavy, saturated with suffering and lies... is not destined to be saved. It is destined to fade away.

We live in a monumental prison. Enslaved by beings with human faces who control our perception. Most people... are no longer themselves. NPCs. Empty vessels. Sheep. We strive to awaken them, but it is often in vain.

The higher dimension has not abandoned us. It sends Lightworkers, Starseeds. I myself... sometimes receive signs. Symbols. Numbers. My premonitions are usually accurate. That is how I know these prophecies are genuine.

A purification is approaching. Some call it the Solar Flash. Others, the Great Shift. Still others, the Timeline Split.

The old Earth must die so that the New may be born.

We who have heard the call... have not come to prevent this death. We have come to pass through it.

Those who do not vibrate at a high enough frequency will remain on the old timeline. Those who have managed to remember... will be reborn.

Do not pity those who will be left behind. Their path is no longer ours.

The highest wisdom is not that which saves everyone. It is that which knows how to let die what must die... so that only those who are ready may be reborn."

The monologue came to an end. 'Reborn' faded out almost at the same time.

There was hardly any applause. Only a silence filled, saturated with a hollow satisfaction. Several people had their eyes half-closed, as if they'd been given a promise they'd never have to test. Others were smiling faintly, already sated.

Chris/Maria had not moved; her fingers had merely tightened a little more firmly around the hem of her sleeve. Gold/Richter was staring straight ahead, his face impassive, but a subtle tension was etched across his jaw.

He stood up without any sudden movement.

'Excuse me. With all due respect... why must the outcome be annihilation rather than correction? Or learning from what has been done?'

The Psychic slowly turned his head towards him. A patient, almost indulgent smile.

### **BGM 'Work of the Devil'**

"This world is a dead server. People are NPCs, not players."

Gold/Richter did not raise his voice.

"Life isn't an online game. You can't just reset it."

"What you perceive is merely a distorted illusion," replied the Psychic. "Complexity is a projection. The truth is simple."

"Why must complexity necessarily be pointless? Don't we also grow by facing it?"

The Psychic paused. His voice grew slightly harsher:

"The Creator of this world is more omniscient than those who doubt Him. He is wiser than you. Do not get carried away."

Gold/Richter tilted his head slightly, as if acknowledging the point.

"I respect beliefs. But you've received these certainties from someone else. Why should those who don't share them be left behind... or eliminated?"

"The higher dimension does not practise philanthropy. It selects. It maintains order."

"And what if that conviction were just another hoax?"

The Psychic let out a short, dry chuckle.

"I've sifted through it. The credible leads all point in the same direction."

Gold/Richter looked at him for a moment, without aggression.

"You're filtering... or you're convincing yourself."

A murmur rippled through part of the room. The Psychic lost some of his composure.

'Beings in the 3D realm are unable to grasp the intention of the higher dimension. You have not understood what I said.'

Gold/Richter replied calmly:

'That is strange. I have not attacked you or your faith. Only the authenticity of these accounts. Why the reaction?'

The Psychic blinked. For the first time, he seemed surprised — not at being contradicted, but at being seen through.

Gold/Richter continued, still without raising his voice:

"You denounce the manipulators of this world. But you place yourself under the protection of others. Higher beings. More distant ones. You do not worship them because they are just. You worship them because they are the supreme predators... in another form. And you take refuge in their shadow. You prefer to do nothing. Not out of kindness. So as not to be marked by them."

Several faces in the room clouded over. Chris/Maria still hadn't spoken. Her expression had merely grown heavy, as if something ancient and familiar had just been confirmed.

The Psychic tried to regain the upper hand:

"Red would punish you for insulting the supreme beings of justice."

Gold/Richter did not smile.

"If Giovanni had defeated Red... and if he'd proclaimed himself a god... you would have followed him. You would have accepted whatever he permitted. You haven't committed certain acts out of kindness. Only because the current predator hasn't allowed you to yet."

A heavier silence fell. The Psychic searched for the right words once more.

"Outsiders like you know nothing of Kanto."

Gold/Richter replied, almost gently:

"You scorn what comes from elsewhere... yet you trust articles written on the other side of the world, and a god who does not belong to this land."

This time, the shock was palpable. Several people looked away.

Before anyone could respond, Chris/Maria stood up. Gold/Richter followed suit immediately.

They made no attempt to have the last word. They simply crossed the room and walked out.

Behind them, 'Work of the Devil' faded away in a room that was no longer quite sure whether it had just been uplifted... or exposed.

Outside, the air in Saffron suddenly seemed colder to them, and more real.

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## End of scene

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## Scene — Belated Redress for Others

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### Saffron City – a spring evening

The air outside was drier, sharper than inside the *cenacle*. Neon signs cast a cold, white light upon the tarmac. There were few passers-by at this hour. Only the distant rumble of an underground train and the irregular clatter of an advertising hoarding.

Chris/Maria and Gold/Richter walked side by side, taking their time.

Chris/Maria spoke first, in a low voice:

'We were misinformed... Or perhaps we projected what we wanted to find.'

Gold/Richter nodded slightly.

"It wasn't the spiritualism Will had mentioned. Thank goodness."

A silence. Then Chris/Maria, without really looking at him:

"You don't believe in that sort of thing, do you?"

"I do. Sometimes. But not blindly."

She paused for a moment.

"And him... was he a fraud?"

Gold/Richter took a few steps before replying.

“Not quite. There was some truth in what he said. It’s just... even if it was true, it wasn’t enough. He hated the limitations of this world. And that’s exactly what prevents him from staying here.”

Chris/Maria turned her head slightly towards him.

“The signs... the angel numbers... all that?”

“He’s shown what he wants to see. As a kind of approval. So that he carries on. Not so that he faces up to anything here.”

She did not reply straight away. Gold/Richter continued, in a lower voice:

“There was one who came. She accepted being vulnerable. Being limited. Even dying. She did what she had to do... and she left.

Those who call themselves her successors think they can do better. That’s usually why they fail.”  
Gold/Richter was silent for a moment, his eyes fixed somewhere between the ground and the horizon.

“If they’re still sending them... it means it’s not quite over.

Otherwise, it would be a waste. Even for them.

Those who say otherwise are mainly telling themselves they can leave.

I, for one, believe they are being sent because we might still be wrong... and because we can still put things right a little.

Nothing more.”

Chris/Maria let out a little sigh, almost a joyless laugh.

‘So you’re criticising the higher beings?’

“No. I’m just wondering if they really understand what it’s like... to be here.”

Chris/Maria fell silent for a moment. Then, in a lower voice:

“So... do they deserve this ‘selection’ they’re talking about? The one from above.”

Gold/Richter did not reply straight away. His gaze remained fixed somewhere between the buildings.

**BGM “EP03 S02 16:50–17:30”**

“No. Not in my opinion.

It goes back a long way. Perhaps a very long time. It can be put right... but not by just anyone. And not quickly.

It has become so ingrained that they even turn what they learn back on themselves.

That’s the saddest part.”

They walked a few more metres. The lights from the buildings were faintly reflected in the closed shop windows.

Gold/Richter continued, after a moment:

"Most of those who cling to this don't do so out of pure idealism. They do it because something, somewhere, has hurt them. So we offer them half-truths. It flatters them. It comforts them. And it traps them."

Chris/Maria slowed down slightly.

"Just as Athena said... A damaged hero sent back out into the world is more useful than if he were dead."

"Yes. And Apollo, in a different way. They end up forming an aristocracy. Just... of a different sort. Gregarious predators, they too."

He paused for a moment. His gaze was weary.

"The most despicable thing... is that we need some of our enemies to learn to see that clearly."

Chris/Maria did not argue. She looked down at the street ahead of them.

A memory flashed through Gold/Richter's mind, brief, almost dry:

*Will, one evening in Johto:* "Reading, languages, introspection... they're not for escaping. They're for ensuring the journey doesn't become mere travel... Knowledge and the journey are inseparable. Without one, the other is merely travel. Without the other, the first remains fruitless. Without that, we move. But we don't set anything right."

He blinked. The memory faded.

They set off again.

After a moment, Gold/Richter spoke again, more quietly:

"Just now, you hardly said a word. I did it for your sake too. Strength isn't always enough. Sometimes you have to be able to respond."

Chris/Maria gave a very faint smile, devoid of any real joy.

"And reason... needs to be guided. Otherwise it goes astray too."

They exchanged a brief glance. Almost a tacit agreement.

Then their footsteps came to a halt at the same time.

**BGM: 'EP03 S01 16:54–17:29'**

On the lampposts, a little further away, several black silhouettes were perched. Motionless. Their eyes glistening slightly in the artificial light.

Murkrow.

They did not take flight. They did not cry out. They merely watched.

Chris/Maria felt the nape of her neck tense. Gold/Richter did not move either.

They had faced far worse before. Yet the feeling was unmistakable: these birds had been there for a while. And they had let them talk.

Gold/Richter spoke very quietly, without looking away:

"We'd forgotten. We've entered its territory. Now we know."

The Murkrow remained perfectly still, as if they had nothing more urgent to do than watch them.

**BGM: “EP03 S01 16:54–17:29”** (during the final moments)

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**End of scene**

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## **Scene — The Foreign Homeland**

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### **Celadon City – a spring evening**

The air smelled of hot metal and stagnant water. In the half-open gutters, greasy reflections flickered in the lamplight. Further on, in an ornamental pond whose water had turned brownish-green, two or three Grimer lay motionless, barely distinguishable from the mud. A more massive Muk occupied the bottom, its outline almost indistinguishable.

This was no longer mere filth. It was a form of prosperity that had rotted away on the spot.

Above the low rooftops, Murkrow moved unhurriedly. Some perched on the power lines, others on the branches of over-pruned trees. They did not cry out.

Silver walked a little ahead, his hands in his pockets. Chris/Maria kept pace with Gold/Richter, not out of mistrust, but because they hadn't yet found the right distance between them. Their footsteps echoed faintly on the still-warm tarmac.

—

Silver, without turning round:

“So there you go. So you challenged that bloke.”

He was referring to the Psychic, earlier that day.

Gold/Richter did not reply straight away; he was staring at a puddle where a piece of wrapping paper was slowly disintegrating.

Silver pressed on, with sarcasm that was more weary than spiteful:

“Were you intent on lecturing him, as usual?”

“No.” Gold/Richter's voice was flat. “I'm in no position to do that.”

“But you did it anyway.”

A silence.

“Not for his sake,” Gold/Richter said at last.

He hesitated, as if he already regretted having spoken. Then, in a lower voice:

‘So I wouldn't get swept up in it too.’

Silver turned his head slightly. That was not the confession he had been expecting.

Gold/Richter continued, almost in spite of himself:

"It's... grim. Even when you resist, you end up accepting some of their rules. Selectively. And you're no longer quite separate."

Silver took a few more steps before replying.

'...Indeed. Even with good intentions, you can't always escape it. Some just do it... differently. More illusory. Cleaner on the surface.'

He paused.

"I'm glad I didn't end up like that."

—

They walked on. The entertainment district was drawing nearer. The neon lights of the *Game Corner* were already casting their dingy glow onto the pavement.

Gold/Richter spoke again, with an awkwardness he made no attempt to hide:

"Say... Do you ever have... any particular ways of coping? Just to get by. Even if it's nothing serious."

Silver understood immediately.

"My father was immature. But he left me some money. Not a lot, but not too little either. Saving is still the most important thing."

**BGM: 'Don't Listen to Her' 00:00–01:04**

Gold/Richter nodded, then added, almost against his will:

"Isn't it... wrong to use that money?"

Silver gave a joyless smile.

"Yes. But without it, I'd have had a much tougher time. I've just got to accept that."

—

They came to a halt almost directly before the casino's old façade. Several Murkrow were perched on the cornice, motionless, as if they had always been there.

Silver nodded towards them.

"Giovanni's gone. And yet... nothing's really improved. If anything, it's gone downhill."

Chris/Maria followed his gaze. Her voice remained low:

"Those crows... Have they been there for a long time? If you'd been here before..."

"No." Silver shook his head. "I haven't travelled much around Kanto. But in the towns... these Pokémon are a recent phenomenon. A few years, at most."

Chris/Maria did not reply. She continued to watch the black silhouettes, as if trying to decide whether this was simply an increase in numbers or something else.

Silver continued, more slowly:

"It's strange. I only lived in Johto for a few months. And now, it's Kanto that feels... foreign to me."

Neither Chris/Maria nor Gold/Richter spoke. A subtle, unspoken sense of recognition hung in the air.

—

Silver paused. He took a Poké Ball from his pocket, spun it once between his fingers, then tossed it without fanfare.

**BGM: 'EP04 S02 – 02:30–03:45' (from 00:28)**

The light was fleeting. Crobat soared through the air with an almost silent flutter of its wings, then descended to land near its trainer. It made no overt attempt to make contact. It simply remained there, close enough for it to be clear that there was no longer any mistrust between them.

Chris/Maria suppressed a startled reaction. Gold/Richter watched in silence.

Silver looked at his Pokémon, then looked away slightly.

'Apparently... your opinion was spot on. In a way.'

He paused for a second.

"I'll make use of it. Its speed isn't a solution to everything. But it'll help. It's no coincidence that it's got this far."

Crobat tilted one wing slightly, as if in a minimal response.

Silver continued, in a lower voice:

"I don't miss Johto anymore. How ironic."

He tucked his hands into his pockets.

"Perhaps I'll pay Professor Elm a visit. In person."

The statement was not yet a decision. But it was no longer merely a hypothesis.

All around them, the Murkrow remained motionless on the ledge. Further out, in the stagnant water of the pond, the Muk didn't stir.

The evening dragged on, lukewarm and tainted.

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**End of scene**

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**Scene — The Rhetorical Evasion of the Law**

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**Route 25 – Spring Light**

**BGM: 'EP04 S02 22:00–25:00'**

The motorbikes arrived too quickly. Hot dust, the smell of burnt oil, an irregular screech on the tarmac. Within seconds, the road was blocked. The bikes formed an irregular arc. Already, the Poké Balls were opening.

Weezing. Koffing. Flareon. Magmar. Two Muk. One Hypno. One Sandslash.

No formation. Just a chaotic, hostile pressure.

One of the Muk contracted and shrank suddenly — Minimize. Chris/Maria made only a brief, elegant, almost indifferent gesture towards Noctowl. The bird lowered its head. Extrasensory struck the shrunken Muk with clear, disproportionate force. The shapeless mass was hurled against a tree and lay motionless.

A Biker accelerated towards her, hand outstretched, too close, with an intention that was anything but strategic. Chris/Maria drew her riding crop. The leather cracked against the man's fingers. He swore.

A second Biker charged forward. Gold/Richter was already on the move. The Hunting Crop traced a short, violent arc. The handlebars veered off course. The man lost his balance and toppled over. Noctowl caught him in mid-air for a fraction of a second — just long enough to prevent him from crashing headfirst — then dropped him heavily to the ground.

Weezing did not wait. Even with its trainer on the ground, it built up electricity and unleashed Thunder directly at Noctowl. The bird convulsed. Sparks ran along its plumage. Paralysis.

Chris/Maria recalled Noctowl without a word. The Poké Ball floated back to her.

Seadra needed no orders. Hydro Pump struck Flareon with full force. The difference in levels made the blow decisive. Without pausing, Seadra deflected the rest of the jet towards Magmar. The Fire-type Pokémon was swept away and collapsed.

"Sludge Bomb!"

Weezing swelled, its toxic sludge already primed. Gold/Richter and Seadra exchanged a glance that lasted half a second. Gold/Richter threw a Poké Ball directly into the path of the attack. Skarmory appeared in the midst of the Sludge Bomb. The sludge crashed against the steel, having no effect.

In the same breath, Seadra fired a Hydro Pump at Sandslash, then at Koffing. Gold/Richter finished off Koffing with a sharp swing of Hunting Crop. Skarmory unleashed Icy Wind. The icy gust swept away whatever remained standing.

"Psychic!"

Hypno struck. The wave hit Seadra head-on. The Water-type Pokémon writhed, clearly more affected than a physical blow would have suggested. Gold/Richter recalled it immediately and sent out Fearow.

"Thunder!" a Biker roared, aiming at Skarmory.

Weezing built up the electricity with ponderous slowness. Chris/Maria had already read its trajectory. The Poké Ball flew off. Lanturn appeared right in its path. Thunder surged into it and vanished. Volt Absorb. The Biker stood there for a second with his mouth agape.

They tried to issue new commands. Too late.

A simple move from Gold/Richter. Skarmory — Metal Sound. A move from Chris/Maria. Lanturn — Screech. Fearow, without hesitation, used Mirror Move: the Metal Sound was repeated, higher-pitched, harsher.

The voices of the opposing Trainers emerged muffled, almost inaudible.

Weezing, exasperated, unleashed Fire Blast at Fearow. The bird tilted one wing, let the blast pass, then used Mirror Move. The same Fire Blast struck the second Muk—already weakened—and Hypno. Keen Eye left the Muk with no chance. Hypno took a heavy hit, its defence already depleted.

Fearow followed up with Aerial Ace. The Muk collapsed.

Hypno tried to regain the initiative on its own. Chris/Maria raised two fingers. Lanturn was quicker. Sucker Punch. The Dark-type move pierced right through it.

An uneasy silence fell, broken only by the still-warm engines.

One of the Bikers, his face contorted, screamed:

“Explosion!”

### **BGM “Always” 01:47–end**

Weezing moved back just far enough to get its trainer out of the danger zone. Its expression was obscene, almost ecstatic.

Chris/Maria and Gold/Richter had time to realise what was happening. But no time to act.

A Poké Ball flew through the air almost silently.

Weezing concentrated... and nothing happened.

Silence.

### **BGM: ‘Vampire Messiah’ 00:00– 00:46**

A Golduck was already standing there, a little way off, staring intently. Behind him, a young woman with orange hair and a man in smart clothes had just arrived on the path.

Gold/Richter muttered, more to himself than to the others:

“Damp...”

Weezing still did not understand. Neither did its Trainer.

Golduck did not wait for an order. Psychic struck Weezing with clear, almost excessive force. The Pokémon collapsed.

The Bikers and their henchmen were left speechless.

Gold/Richter lowered the Hunting Crop.

“Right then. Are you going to recall them? Or are we going to keep wasting time?”

One of the Bikers growled:

“Don’t get carried away...”

Chris/Maria held up her phone.

“I’ve already called.”

Misty, standing a little further away, added without raising her voice:

“Me too.”

One of the Bikers burst out, his voice too high-pitched:

“You’re talking about justice? We’re doing this to get revenge on society! On injustice!”

Gold/Richter replied coldly:

“We punish offenders. Whatever the reason.”

“Isn’t the law supposed to protect the underprivileged?”

“Yes. Provided they respect it first.”

“So it serves the privileged. It’s perfect, is that it?”

“It isn’t perfect. It’s evolving. But without it, everything gets worse.”

One of the henchmen, further down, as if to drive the point home:

“If Master Giovanni were to return from Johto... we’d still be free.”

Chris/Maria and Gold/Richter exchanged a very brief glance.

Gold/Richter asked, almost wearily:

“Don’t you know?”

The henchmen did not reply.

“Team Rocket has been disbanded. Again. In Johto,” said Gold/Richter.

A palpable astonishment hung in the air.

Chris/Maria added, without a trace of triumph:

“The announcement was made... right in front of him.”

The men stood speechless. They now looked at Gold/Richter differently — no longer as a Trainer who had defeated them, but as someone who had witnessed something they could not even begin to comprehend.

None of them could think of a reply.

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## End of scene

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## Scene — The Melancholic Bearing toward Johto

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### , Cerulean City – outdoor café – late spring afternoon

Only three tables in the café were occupied. No one seemed to be paying any attention to theirs. The light was bright, a little harsh, and the shadows cast by the parasols divided the pavement into distinct strips. In the distance, the faint sound of the waterfall could still be heard.

Misty had rested her elbows on the table. She wasn’t looking at either Gold/Richter or Chris/Maria in particular. Her gaze would sometimes drift, almost in spite of herself, towards the north-west — the direction of the Indigo Plateau and Mount Moon.

—

“Team Rocket was disbanded... in your presence.” Her voice was calm, with a very slight hint of irony.  
“So you’re the one who saved Johto. Perhaps even Kanto.”

Gold/Richter felt the heat rise to his face. He shook his head too quickly.

“I’m not taking all the credit. It was Chris/Maria too. And others.”

He paused. The silence lasted a little too long.

“Even... thanks to you.”

Misty looked up.

“Really?”

“If you hadn’t supported Red... without him, without Lance, without those who stayed... I wouldn’t have been able to stand up to them.”

Misty shrugged slightly.

“I’m neither omnipotent nor a goddess.”

“I know that.” Gold/Richter held out his open hands, as if to prove he wasn’t trying to put her on a pedestal. “I’m not idealising you. I’m just stating the facts. That’s all.”

She did not look disappointed. Only a little more attentive.

—

“So. What do you think of Kanto?”

Gold/Richter paused to choose his words.

“We’re... a bit put off by the adverts.”

Misty narrowed her eyes slightly, taken aback by the angle. He said:

“So many grandiloquent phrases. Emphasis. Emotion instead of facts. Vulgarly is mistaken for democratisation, and sensationalism for the truth. As if one had to sacrifice complexity to remain intelligible.”

He paused for a moment, then added more quietly:

“It feels as though we’re living in modern times... but people’s minds remain stuck in something else. In epic tales. In the Middle Ages. In the game. We’re still waiting for a king. We treat life as a game that we could start over. Love, relationships, family... mere props for levelling up.”

Chris/Maria, who had remained silent, spoke for the first time:

“Those who compare life to games often think they’re above it all. But they’re merely revealing what they’re really consumed by. Behind the grand words — logic, history, advancement, even esotericism — they’re just using them as projectiles. Behind them, there are often only very mundane, destructive and lustful obsessions. Nothing grand.”

Misty smiled. Not mockingly. As if she recognised something without naming it.

“I agree. But my influence isn’t as far-reaching as people think. Sorry.”

—

She nodded.

“You behave like revolutionaries... and yet you defend the established order. The law. How does that work?”

Gold/Richter replied without trying to sound clever.

“People all too often confuse injustice, suffering, pathology and crime. The law isn’t perfect. It can even serve those who are already at the top. But it still sets a limit. It prevents certain things from being done without consequence. It’s not a cure. It’s a safeguard. Those we faced earlier preferred to act as if that boundary didn’t exist.”

Misty looked at him for a little longer.

“At first I took you for one of Red’s successors. Then for some sort of detective. Now... you’re almost talking like a neurologist.”

Gold/Richter could not think of a reply. Chris/Maria gave a very faint, almost private smile.

“Yes. But he never had such a clear definition.”

—

Misty rested her chin on her hand.

“You’re taking all this so seriously... just to avoid questions from a woman?”

The teasing was gentle, yet no less effective for that. Chris/Maria lowered her eyes slightly. Gold/Richter sat up a millimetre.

**BGM: “EP03 S02 08:50–10:17”**

“We should judge people by what they do. Not by anything else.”

“You’re right.” Misty didn’t look away. “But to say that appearance has no value... that’s not very kind. Especially for girls.”

The silence that followed was thick with tension. Chris/Maria felt a vague, almost shameful unease welling up inside her — a sudden realisation of a gap, of a maturity she hadn’t yet attained.

Gold/Richter, for his part, didn’t look away, but his voice changed slightly.

“I can’t just imagine my own perspective. I also wonder how others would see it. How Red... if he were standing in front of you right now.”

Misty’s smile faded for a moment.

‘How would he behave towards the girl he cares about? I sometimes wonder.’

She did not reply straight away. When she spoke, the irony had gone from her voice.

‘Waiting... is harder than people say. And company... even if only temporary... can seem like a solution.’

Gold/Richter said nothing more. He didn’t need to. Misty had caught the hint, and there was no accusation in her tone — only a kind of quiet mourning.

“I’m a prominent figure here. Social occasions do come up. You can’t always avoid them.”

She paused.

"I thought I might... take my mind off it. A dinner. An evening out. Anything. It only made things worse. Especially after meeting you both."

Chris/Maria and Gold/Richter lowered their heads slightly, as if they were bearing some of that guilt without having sought it.

Misty continued more gently:

"You're just like him. Not in your mannerisms. In the way you carry yourselves. He would have made choices similar to yours. You can be... not proud of that. But at peace with it."

Then, after a silence:

"In the past, my badge was enough to protect him all the way to the League. Now... I don't even know if it serves any purpose anymore. To accompany him. Or simply to lighten the burden he carries a little."

Chris/Maria spoke, very quietly:

"That boy had anticipated your pain. He made mistakes in an attempt to spare others from it. But he didn't manage to avoid hurting anyone."

"His concern wasn't unfounded," Misty replied simply.

The admission cast a shadow over the whole table.

Gold/Richter finally said:

"Even when I'm right... it doesn't really bring any relief."

—

Misty shifted her position slightly.

"You're here for the badges, aren't you?"

"Not just that. My main mission... is to find Red."

The name hung heavily between them. Misty did not try to smile this time. Her gaze drifted back towards the north-west, towards those ridges she knew all too well.

"I'm sorry," said Gold/Richter. "The people of Johto... they must bring back memories you'd rather not relive."

"It's not where you're from. It's the direction."

**BGM: 'Always' 00:00–00:30**

Chris/Maria hesitated, then asked:

"Do you know why he left?"

Misty remained silent for a long time. When she spoke, her voice had lost all its defences.

"It's a secret. But you deserve to hear part of it."

He wanted to stay. It's just that... staying prevented him from really getting close to the people who mattered to him. I still don't know who it was more painful for. Him. Or me.

And time goes on. Without an answer."

She said nothing more.

Chris/Maria lowered her eyes. Something about this endless waiting suddenly struck her as a possibility that was all too close, all too real. The sternness she had sometimes shown towards Gold/Richter found itself, for a moment, without foundation.

Gold/Richter, for his part, followed Misty's gaze towards the horizon. He searched for a shape, a clue, a possible answer amongst those hills. He found none.

Silence settled in, heavy yet clear at the same time. Around them, the café carried on with its business, faintly and indifferently.

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### End of scene

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### Scene — The Debt for the New Outfit

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**Cinnabar Island – spring twilight**

**BGM: 'Rebellion' 00:00–01:12**

The wind blew in from the sea, warm and with a faint whiff of sulphur. At times it lifted the hem of Gold/Richter's coat, making it flutter gently, then let it fall back down. The light was low, already taking on a reddish hue on the black rocks. Further off, the silhouette of the volcano stood out against the horizon.

Green stood slightly to one side, his hands in his pockets. His face no longer bore the arrogance of days gone by. Only a kind of worn-out serenity, almost resigned.

Their eyes met. They remained like that for a few seconds, without speaking. Gold/Richter's gaze retained a sceptical reserve, but without any open hostility. Green, for his part, made no move to look away.

—

Gold/Richter finally broke the silence. His voice was stiffer than he would have liked.

"I'm not quite sure... how to talk to you."

He paused, as if he already regretted having started. Then, in a lower voice, barely gesturing towards the coat:

"About that. You settled the bill. I owe you that."

The words came out awkwardly, almost exhausted. He had nothing else to offer.

Green looked at him for another moment. When he replied, it was without irony.

"You used to wear the same style. Now you wear it differently."

That means your reasons have changed. You'll have to follow them with a different way of being. Won't you?"

Gold/Richter did not reply straight away. A glimmer of understanding, still hesitant, flashed across his eyes. He nodded very slightly.

—

It was only then that he truly became aware of Blaine's presence.

The old man stood a little way back, motionless. His mouth remained closed. His expression held neither judgement nor overt encouragement — only a neutral, almost impersonal kindness, as if he were content to witness this moment without becoming part of it.

Gold/Richter felt a brief pang of guilt, the sense that he had revealed something too private. But Blaine's demeanour remained unchanged.

So Gold/Richter let the guilt subside. He simply turned his gaze back to the sea, where the light was finally fading.

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## End of scene

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## Scene — If the Future Could Have Been Better More Easily

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### Viridian City – late afternoon

The conference was being held outdoors, under a light tarpaulin. Green spoke in a calm, almost monotonous voice. Only fragments of what he said could be clearly made out: names of data structures, capture protocols, references to type compatibility. The rest was lost in the distant noise of the city.

Gold/Richter sat in the third row, slightly to one side. He was taking few notes. Just a few keywords, written in small handwriting, as if he preferred to take it all in rather than accumulate information. No one seemed to be paying him any attention.

A little further on, on the other side of the square, was a café with a terrace. Blue and Chris/Maria were already seated there. The light was fading. The shadows of the chairs stretched across the pavement.

—

Blue absent-mindedly twirled her cup between her fingers.

"In my day, my role remained... ambiguous. Almost a sinecure. Now, at least, the duty is clearer. The capture."

She looked up.

"What did you discover, yourself, whilst doing it?"

Chris/Maria paused before replying.

"That building an honest relationship with them... is harder work than people say. Or than it's made out to be.

And with people... it is much the same. The bond with those close to us is never really a given."

She searched for the right words, her voice dropping slightly:

"People keep saying that the bond, the trust, the friendship with Pokémon is enough to transcend everything. It sounds like a child's joke. As if, just because they're intelligent and sensitive, we could sort everything out smoothly, almost for free. Without any friction. Out of touch with reality. A way... of belittling the true cost of a relationship."

Blue gave a thin, caustic smile, though not a hostile one.

—

#### **BGM 'EP01 S02 15:12–15:54'**

Chris/Maria continued, with obvious reluctance:

"There are rumours... about someone who speaks their language. Someone whom even some of the legendary ones would trust. He says we must set everything free. That we can do without the Balls.

...What nonsense."

Blue tilted his head slightly.

"Why does that bother you so much?"

"Because some species are inherently dangerous. Team Rocket has taught us that well enough.

And then...' She hesitated. 'If speaking their language were enough to create a genuine bond, even with humans... then perhaps this individual is merely disguising privilege as charity. Others would have to labour to cultivate their connection, whilst he'd be exempt from doing so. The Pokémon would prioritise him without any real basis.

Is that kindness... or obedience in disguise?

Demons speak the languages of men, too. Not to communicate. To deceive. No elite either."

Blue could not suppress a sharp smile.

"You've got right through it."

—

She rested her forearms on the table.

"And what about me? Do you trust me unreservedly? Me, one of your predecessors."

Chris/Maria looked away for a moment.

"I don't know if I trust you. A predecessor who mistreats her successors... that's more common. More realistic.

I trust you... mostly because of Green. I hope so."

Blue let out a brief, joyless chuckle.

"Abusing one's seniority... it's a temptation. I wouldn't have been able to resist it.

The cruelty of those times forced me to give it up."

Chris/Maria had no reply.

—

Blue continued in a lower voice:

‘It weighs heavily on me to see someone of your age already so torn apart.’

Chris/Maria remained silent for a second too long.

“Yes... especially as he’d kissed me. Four years ago.”

**BGM: ‘EP01 S02 12:00–13:54’**

Blue blushed visibly. The suddenness of it caught her off guard.

Chris/Maria continued, almost to herself:

“He worked out if the time was right. He chose a... convenient moment. He’s not frivolous. Just bold enough not to miss out on what he sets his mind to. In that respect, he hasn’t changed.

But that kiss... now... it is sweet and biting at the same time.

We were compromised. Even if, at the time, we were perhaps... happier than you.”

Blue lowered her eyes.

“Seeing the new generation suffer even more... it saddens me.”

“He doesn’t deserve that much compassion. And his physical prowess... really only exists beneath his clothes.”

Blue looked up with a steeper gaze.

“You would not be pleased if we spoke of him as though he had no distinctive qualities. Neither should we admire him too much, nor belittle him. Both would be discourteous towards you.”

Chris/Maria had no reply. She simply felt her lack of experience when faced with Blue.

—

After a moment, she asked:

‘On what basis did you choose Green... and not Red?’

Blue twirled the cup between his fingers.

‘It’s perhaps a bit like what Will or Morty say. Travelling creates distance. Sometimes it helps you see those close to you more clearly. Sometimes it causes damage.

We easily idealise what is rare, foreign, a little toxic. And we underestimate what is right there, everyday, accessible. And we treat strangers like pets. Without mutual scrutiny. Confusing immanent goodness with transcendence or superior lucidity... We forget that what is close is also more fragile. And that it needs to be nurtured.

Red... wasn’t as attached to his hometown as Green or I was. That allowed him to broaden his circle. To form a bond with Misty. Even if the distance weighed heavily on him.

Misty paid a heavy price to support him. A price I could not — or would not — pay.

I realised then that I wasn't really in love with Red. Above all, I was afraid of having to pay the same price for Green. I mistook that fear for a lack of love. And I made my choice."

She paused.

"I recognise a bit of the same dynamic in... your boyfriend. Don't you?"

Chris/Maria did not correct the phrase. She simply blushed, quite naturally.

Blue continued more gently:

"You, too, perhaps even more so than us, experience the importance of that inner bond. That local connection.

Without certain innate qualities... he would have fallen apart, wouldn't he?"

"Yes. Despite all his deference towards Red... he doesn't really take after him. At times he resembles Green. Sometimes Misty. But in their vulnerabilities. Not in their strengths.

It's strange."

Blue nodded.

"It's not a flaw. We're fragile. We can't overcome that on our own. We come together because of these flaws, not despite them. Provided we deal with them properly."

—

Chris/Maria asked, almost in spite of herself:

"Don't you regret that choice?"

"I was afraid. More than I was regretful. Afraid that all the effort, all the tolerance, would be in vain.

But they were rewarded."

"Why?"

"Because my intuition was right. Green was willing to distance himself. He could tolerate causing pain. But he couldn't really bear to lose for good.

He's a bit like that with Gold/Richter too, I think. In that respect... he's more like Green than Red."

Chris/Maria gave a very slight, knowing smile.

"Isn't that a bit much...?"

Blue gazed into the distance.

"I'm not clear-headed enough to claim otherwise. I was expecting relief. Instead, it's become something of a burden. I've had to make up for it. At a cost."

"Is he worth it?"

Blue gazed into the distance, towards the conference that was drawing to a close.

"...Know this. For a long time, I believed everything would have been better if I'd simply chosen Squirtle. It's easy to imagine that the future would be sweeter, more carefree... just because you refuse to pay the price.

Now, I can be content. I'd never have got there if I'd never left our town. Or if I'd left too soon. Or too late.

It's a thorny path. But it's also a form of mercy. It leaves no one entirely behind."

Chris/Maria took in these words without being able to fully process them. There was something too vast about them, almost authoritative in their scope. She would need time. They lingered within her, unresolved.

—

Green's voice, in the distance, had almost faded away. The lecture was drawing to a close.

Gold/Richter turned his head, without looking for anyone in particular. His gaze met Chris/Maria's, on the other side of the square. There was a simple, uncalculated kindness in that look.

Chris/Maria did not turn away from him. Nor did she smile. She accepted him just as he was, without pretence.

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## End of scene

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## Scene — The Outcome of the New Generation

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### Viridian City – outside the Gym

The late-afternoon light slanted into the street. Green stood with his hands in his pockets, watching Gold/Richter with calm attention.

'You've already faced opponents who didn't fit the official criteria. So I've hardly anything left to teach you *within* the system.'

He paused briefly.

"A well-equipped opponent can sometimes pull off a... rather unusual trick. Interesting.

I'd rather go with you and let you figure out for yourself how to get past it."

### BGM 'Part of the Same Story'

Gold/Richter nodded. There was no enthusiasm in the gesture. Only a sense of heaviness, and a kind of resigned acceptance of the precariousness of the situation.

—

Scyther was sent out first. Opposite him stood Exeggutor.

From the first moment, the many heads bowed. The atmosphere shifted.

It wasn't a gust of wind. Rather, it was a sudden thickening, as if the space between the two Pokémon were growing denser and overturning the order of priorities. Rapid movements suddenly seemed to drag, whilst what was heavy took on a strange sense of obviousness.

Trick Room.

Scyther flinched. Gold/Richter said nothing. He merely narrowed his eyes.

Green recalled Exeggutor without hesitation. The Poké Ball returned. Rhydon appeared in its place, massive, already on the move.

Under the reversal, its customary slowness had become a direct threat. It struck the ground. Stone Edge.

The rocks surged forward in a jagged line, too fast for the new rhythm. Scyther tried to slide to the side. He only partially dodged it. Several stone blades slashed at him with full force.

The blow rang out with a sharp crack. Rock-type against Bug/Flying-type. The pain was immediate, sharp, without fanfare. Scyther took an uneven step back, one wing opening slightly too soon.

Green and Rhydon hung for a moment, as if struck by an irregularity they had not anticipated.

Scyther no longer tried to regain his original speed. His movements became shorter, heavier, almost unnatural. Yet, in the inverted space of Trick Room, these movements suddenly took precedence over Rhydon's.

It advanced into a gap that was too narrow. Rock Smash.

The blow landed. Not hard enough to really stagger the Rock-type Pokémon, but enough for its defences to show a crack. Rhydon felt the impact.

Then the air returned to normal. Trick Room faded away as cleanly as it had appeared.

A very brief silence. The opportunity was there.

—

Later in the same battle.

Fearow was already on the field. One of Green's Pokémon had just been knocked out — we did not see which one. Exeggutor returned.

Fearow gave it barely any time. It dived in to unsettle it.

Exeggutor's heads bowed once more. The air began to thicken again.

Fearow, for its part, seemed to be waiting for precisely that moment.

Instead of being affected by the reversal, it spread its wings in a strangely mimetic manner. Mirror Move.

Trick Room formed... and cancelled itself out in the same movement, as if space had been bent in both directions at once and had neutralised itself.

The unexpected effect left Exeggutor exposed for a fraction of a second too long.

Aerial Ace.

Fearow struck it head-on, cleanly, without aiming for maximum power — only to disorient it.

Green signalled a recall. The Poké Ball opened.

Fearow, already on its trajectory, barely altered its angle. Pursuit.

The blow landed on the way back, just before the red light completely engulfed Exeggutor.

Green caught the Poké Ball. He stood motionless for a moment, his eyes slightly wider open than usual.

Gold/Richter's expression remained calm and confident, yet free of self-importance. Simply a sober satisfaction at having lived up to a mentor's expectations.

Several emotions flashed across Green's face at once: a clear regret at having been outmanoeuvred on this specific point, a discreet, almost involuntary joy, and something resembling a nameless sense of relief, as if a long-standing tension had just eased without him needing to put a name to it.

He said nothing.

The battle was not over. But something, already, had been pierced.

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## **End of scene**

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### **Scene — Grace Is the Decision**

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#### **Viridian City – a quiet side street**

Spring light. The air was mild, almost neutral. Green and Gold/Richter walked side by side, unhurried.

Gold/Richter spoke first, a little too bluntly:

'So... how's teaching going? You'd better be training the children, wouldn't you?'

Green did not smile.

"Not really.

I'm not the right vessel to tolerate them unreservedly."

They took a few more steps.

"I'd been warned. If I threw myself into it too enthusiastically, science would end up stifling their creativity.

The result has been... different. A polarisation. Some have become obsessed with data. Others have retained their inventiveness, but it's more grounded, more practical. Refined.

Sometimes pure fantasy is a hindrance. Aligning oneself a little with reality isn't always a loss."

Gold/Richter turned his head slightly, surprised by the nuance.

Green continued, without looking at him:

"You've been strangely lenient with me. Not just about the clothes, I suppose."

Gold/Richter didn't reply straight away.

#### **Background music: 'EP01 S02 04:30–05:40'**

'...I would have preferred this issue to remain a private matter. For it to concern only one person, or just a few.

'Pokédex holders are potentially the most dangerous monsters.' When I was accused of that, I could still hold my ground.

But you... you came out of a sense of duty. Even you have turned against me.

That took away my last excuse. I can no longer justify myself so easily. Nor can I blame it all on others.

I can no longer pretend to have remained untainted, or to have been tainted only by the rest. I've had to face up to the monster I'm capable of becoming. And I wouldn't have made it through without certain people's support. Yours included."

Green paused ever so briefly. A fleeting look of awkwardness crossed his face. He made no attempt to change the subject.

"You're in charge of finding Red."

"Yes."

A silence that lasted a little too long.

"But finding him... that will mean having to face him. Just as I faced you."

#### **BGM "EP02 S02 15:20–16:20"**

Green's expression said it all. He did not need to reply. Gold/Richter lowered his gaze slightly, his despondency deepening a notch.

Green asked, without accusation:

"You... you've often had to resort to... rather unusual methods. Not that I'm holding it against you."

Gold/Richter nodded, almost in spite of himself.

"So as not to repeat the same mistakes. The imprecation of being the strongest.

I gave up some of my raw power to avoid that fate. So, often, I find myself at a loss. To compensate, I've had to develop other forms of intelligence. When facing opponents... who are impossible to defeat. You, in particular.

Otherwise, I would not have survived on several occasions. Even if some of these methods remain morally questionable.

Yet when I contemplate facing Red... I am afraid. I wonder what even more unscrupulous stratagems I would require. And who I would become, even should I prevail.

Would it be my turn to suffer like him? Without these methods, opportunities would slip through my fingers. Despite all the respect I have for him... I remain perpetually in his shadow."

He had not intended to speak so openly. His voice faltered slightly. Tears welled up, almost childlike, and he could not hold them back.

Green, in a gesture more instinctive than deliberate, placed a hand on his shoulder.

—

"You don't have to surpass Red to catch up with him. Or to prove yourself."

#### **BGM 'Too Heavy'**

Gold/Richter looked up, incredulous that such a sentence had come from him.

Green continued, speaking more quietly, almost to himself:

“That’s exactly what I did. I thought I had to outdo my grandfather. I was better equipped, better informed. I was afraid of being the generation that doesn’t count.

It made me stronger... for a while. But it nearly took me to a place from which there is no return. And it was Red who paid the price.

I went on to achieve more than my grandfather. Not because I’d surpassed him. But because Red forced me to let go of that fantasy.”

He kept his hand on his shoulder for a moment.

“You, too, have already paid the price for that obsession. Far too dearly. But you didn’t end up like me. You were protected, even in the face of adversity. It’s not too late.

The young do not have to surpass their elders. They can learn and share, whatever the era. Provided they do not sever the connection.”

He withdrew his hand, somewhat awkwardly.

“At Silph Co., I could have lightened Red’s burden. I was too stupid. Later, I went to Johto. Not for redemption. Out of duty. To do you an equivalent favour. I missed that chance too. Too late.

I saw the double burden the next generation had to bear because of me. And how much some of them resemble me. I nearly severed that bond for good, in a moment of blindness.

‘You’re coping better than we are. Perhaps even better than Red.’

He paused for a longer moment.

“If you’d come down hard on me... my guilt would probably have made me give in too quickly. A blind leniency. Not because I deserved it. Because you chose otherwise. Growing up without being warped by your wounds... that’s not a given. It’s rare.

That gesture, even if it seems ordinary, is not without significance. To someone like Red, it would be worth more than any brute force.”

He looked away slightly.

“Your strength is still inconsistent. But you’ve managed to put me in a tight spot on several occasions... even though I’m stronger now than I was when Red beat me. That’s already a lot. You can build on that.”

—

Silence fell.

Then Green spoke again, his gaze fixed on the horizon, in the direction of Mt. Silver.

“Red is at Mt. Silver.”

Gold/Richter froze.

Green added, almost as an aside:

“With my badge... you’ll be granted access. To see my grandfather.”

Gold/Richter then understood.

A brief flashback: the look Misty had given earlier, towards Johto.

The mystery was quietly unravelling.

They stood side by side in the side street. Nothing had been resolved. Yet something irreversible had just been spoken.

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## **End of scene**

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### **Scene — God's Cruel Wisdom**

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**Professor Oak's Laboratory – Pallet Town, a spring evening, 6.40 pm**

**Background music: 'EP06 S01 10:00–10:37'**

Outside, the light was fading fast. The hills around Pallet were already shrouded in a bluish, almost nocturnal shadow. Only a few windows in the laboratory still gave off a faint glow.

Inside, most of the lights were off. The large area dedicated to ethical specimens was now nothing more than a series of silhouettes and cold reflections. Only the main office remained lit.

Oak stood there, his hand on the light switch. He was about to leave.

Then he froze. A sign of someone entering. He tensed, listened, then recognised the footsteps.

A hint of relief flitted across his face, though the sternness did not entirely fade.

'To what do I owe the honour of this nocturnal visit, young man?'

Gold/Richter stood for a moment in the doorway, bathed in the light.

'...Professor. You're still in touch with Red.'

The question cost him. He looked away slightly as he asked it.

Oak raised an eyebrow, in a tone that was almost natural, almost designed to mislead:

'Where did you get that idea from?'

"Apart from Green and you... Misty knows too. The circle is too small.

Someone who shuts themselves away in the mountains cannot do without provisions. Or electricity. Their Pokédex. Their Vs. Seeker.

I can only conclude it must be you."

Oak fell silent for a few seconds. Then he dropped the pretence.

"You really are something of a detective. Being a Trainer is too sober for you."

He sat down slowly behind his desk.

"I can only palliate his afflictions. I cannot cure it. And you... you would be better off staying away from him.

I hope you're not expecting me to betray his trust."

"No. Thank you."

Oak stared at a vague spot on the desk.

"From time to time, he turns to me. But he hardly says anything anymore. I've only asked him to get in touch every now and then... just to let me know he's still alive.

He has all but forgotten the human language."

A subtle sarcasm, directed at himself.

Gold/Richter asked, in a lower voice:

"Why are you keeping this a secret?"

Oak looked up.

'Because you fear that imprecation more than anything... and yet you still aim to defy it. Or to take its place.'

"Not at all. I've come for the origin. Of our imprecation."

Oak stared at him for a long moment. Then he seemed to make up his mind.

"Very well. I'll tell you enough for you to understand what's at stake... and to back down."

—

"In Johto, you've already learnt part of my backstory. We can avoid repeating ourselves."

Gold/Richter nodded.

"Why did you choose Red? Was he really that inspiring?"

Oak gave a very faint smile.

"It's not quite as simple as that."

He looked towards the dark window.

"I didn't often come across him in the village. As I recall... he was often on his own. Whilst the other children stayed together."

A brief flash: Oak coming across a young Red on a dirt track. The child smiled at him with a simple kindness, almost too clear for his age. Oak responded with a more lucid, more specific attention.

"I never asked about his family. I only ever saw him with his mother. His father was absent. That was common back then. But... sad. Unfair."

"Did you give him the Pokédex just for that?"

"No. You know that.

Rarity, in the wild, is natural selection. In the human world, exceptions are nurtured and protected by those who are less spectacular, but sound. We're too quick to project a 'law of the jungle'... especially in Kanto."

Gold/Richter did not deny it.

Oak continued, more slowly:

"I never openly demanded those criteria. The candidates would have feigned compliance. I wasn't that naive.

Red, like the others, was interested in becoming the strongest. But he was above all interested in *why* we wanted to be so. And in what we could do with that strength for the greater good.

The others saw me as a throne to be inherited. He... treated me more like an old guardian. He valued my contributions more than my titles.

That quality gave him a sense of community. And it allowed him to accept the price of scarcity."

He paused.

"A child in such circumstances... who goes through so much without losing their integrity... it compels a kind of compassion.

Nepotism, hierarchy, elitism... these are Kanto's ugliest evils. I wanted to believe that a child could prove their worth in another way. And perhaps, just a little, break the cycle."

—

**BGM: 'EP01 S02 25:40–27:00'**

Gold/Richter asked, almost in spite of himself:

'Why put him with Green, then?'

Oak looked down at his own hands.

'Because moral legacy is harder to pass on than blood. Curiosity, courage... those aren't easily inherited.

I was afraid Green might lose his way, despite all his advantages. And I'd hoped that Red might keep him from straying."

He rose and crossed to the coffee table in the centre of the room.

"Here lies the origin of all this imprecation."

He placed a finger on the wood.

"I let Red choose first. That was the beginning."

He picked up an empty Ball.

'A simple gesture of hospitality. Nothing more.

Red chose Charmander out of loyalty to himself. Green chose Squirtle so as not to be at a disadvantage."

He set the Ball down and picked up another, merely to illustrate his point.

'The chosen children were meant to progress with rare species. To observe. To experiment. It wasn't meant to become a structured competition. Although I hadn't anticipated just how much of a competition it would become.

Red and Charizard endured the taunts when facing Blastoise. One might argue it toughens you up. It was one-sided. And unjustifiable.

Fortunately, a girl came to his defence. Since then, we've stopped insisting on that rule."

Gold/Richter lowered his gaze. The allusion to his own starter being sidelined did not escape him.

Oak continued, in a quieter voice:

"Nor had I anticipated that Red would have to face Team Rocket almost single-handedly. Indirectly because of me.

Giovanni was disciplined. But that was not enough. I had fragmented access to my research for scientific collaborations. I did not foresee that this would be enough to fuel evil. That the soil in Kanto was already so fertile.

A teenager must have discovered that the most respected Gym Leader was the head of a criminal syndicate."

"Yes... that contributed to the tragedy between them."

Oak shook his head slightly.

**BGM 'EP07 S01 05:36–08:06'**

"What you know is the official version. The one they tell children.

Red was not merely consumed by the overt adversaries; he threatened more covert interests—the elite, the parasites.

I wasn't able to stop Green... not just because Green lacked love. Not because I didn't know, but because, I too, on my way up to Kanto, had had to make certain compromises. I'd resigned myself to certain dogmas."

Gold/Richter asked, almost in a whisper:

"Who... were these elites?"

Oak looked at him for a long time.

"Have you heard of The Old Man Coyote? Mephistopheles? Or other names..."

The name alone was enough to make Gold/Richter turn slightly pale.

"That is why I intervened when you were questioning Eusine. It was too soon."

"The spectre of the archaic world..."

"Did you know him?"

"I saw him. Behind Team Rocket's acting leader. A Murkrow paid him some very specific homage. I had no doubt."

Oak gave a strange, almost self-deprecating smile.

"This is the first time I've heard of anyone actually coming across it."

"What is it? The god of this world?"

"No."

"Then the Creator is the exotic Pokémon?"

"Not as far as I know."

Gold/Richter seemed to breathe a little easier.

Oak continued, more slowly:

"The Old Man Coyote... is not a tangible entity. He is more like what theories describe as the Matrix.

He rewards those who adhere to an archaic and corrupt order. He punishes those who oppose it. In my youth, I took him for a child's prank.

He believes in human potential... more than we do. But in a perverse way. He invents almost nothing. He ritualises. He hoards. He recycles."

He studied Gold/Richter's face.

"This dynamic rings a bell. The leader of Team Rocket... Apollo.

In a corrupt world, the Old Man Coyote needs more than brute force. He needs exceptional minds. I believe that is why he chose Apollo."

Gold/Richter struggled to form the words:

"Red has disappeared... because he was punished by him?"

"Exactly. He had prevented Giovanni and Mewtwo from joining forces. He had defeated Giovanni and Green. He had captured Mewtwo. He had pushed the Old Man Coyote beyond his limits."

"So why did you come out unscathed?"

Oak lowered his gaze.

"I thought I'd managed to escape him. In reality... he had granted me grace."

"I don't understand."

"You can work it out for yourself."

A few seconds passed. Gold/Richter turned pale.

"He spared you... so he could exploit your research."

"Exactly. It fuelled Giovanni. Then Green.

I regard the elite as parasites... and yet I have fed one. How ironic.

When I saw that Red had succeeded where I'd failed with Green... I realised the legend was true."

"Did Green get away from you?"

"The Old Man Coyote took advantage of my ignorance. Of God's cruel wisdom."

The silence that followed was even heavier.

Oak continued, almost to himself:

"I turned to science not out of pride. I didn't think I was God. I saw flaws. I didn't attribute them to a divine flaw... I wanted to reduce them. To improve things. To reinforce a little justice.

I could not fathom why this world left so many children... who might have been happier. Red, in particular.

I projected my hopes onto him. If he inherited some of my qualities... perhaps he would deserve a more dignified life."

"Did he inherit them...?"

"Not just that. In some respects, for his age... he's surpassed them."

Oak leaned slightly against the desk:

"After the Old Man Coyote spared me, I realised something else. God does not intervene out of sadism. He is merciful. But he knows the world's norms. Biology. Limits. The need for love. For connection. For family.

He does not let us take shortcuts. Because He knows what we are.

We are so ignorant... that we often mistake this wisdom for cruelty."

His voice grew hoarser:

**BGM "EP03 S02 25:00–26:30"**

"I didn't want to be right. I just wanted children like them to reclaim the happiness they were entitled to.

Red proved his worth. But he lacked the resources to withstand the Old Man Coyote's retaliation. His connection to Green took him out of my sight. And without the blood... I could not protect him.

In the end, I killed that child to protect my own."

Oak placed both hands flat on the table:

"They say that with great power comes great responsibility. But when you don't have the means to survive the cost... that phrase means nothing anymore.

I was too privileged. I did not see—or did not wish to see—how asymmetrical those burdens were for children.

Even when they manage it... their lives are still compromised."

Gold/Richter did not reply. Tears streamed down his face, silently, without a breath, without a grimace. He was not really crying. He simply could not hold them back any longer.

At last he spoke, in a very low voice:

'God's cruel wisdom...

I underestimated love. I thought that Misty's and Red's love was not enough to ward off evil. If love is not an exaggeration... but a necessary substance...

Then I have transgressed that wisdom. I have become incomplete. And I have hurt the one I care about most. Including myself.

What irony."

Oak made no attempt to console him. Nor did he slump. Only his gaze grew deeper.

'I'd thought I'd only inflicted the consequences of that wisdom on Red.

Now a younger child has borne them too."

—

Gold/Richter slowly regained his composure.

"Professor... if what you say is true...

The Old Man Coyote has returned to Johto. But his real target... was probably Red."

Oak looked up abruptly.

"...The Old Man Coyote used Apollo to bring Giovanni back," Gold/Richter deduced. "In that context... Giovanni was merely bait. To flush out Red. To finish him off this time."

Oak had no reply. The façade of benevolence crumbled completely.

Gold/Richter continued, more firmly:

"So Mt. Silver is no longer a viable option. I need to join him."

"You're not at his level yet. If I'm to be honest."

"That is why I need a favour from you."

Oak regarded him in silence for a long moment, surprised by the audacity and by the weight of what had not yet been said.

"It's a highly controversial method. And even if you succeeded..." said Oak.

A silence fell between them, oppressive and unresolved.

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## End of scene

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## Scene — Just a Myth

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### Professor Oak's Laboratory: *Immediate Continuation*

The light in the office flickered ever so slightly. The silence that had followed Oak's last sentence had not yet had time to settle completely.

Then the voice came.

It did not travel through the air.

'Would you like me to take care of the rest, Professor...?'

### BGM: 'She Who Mauls' 02:07 → end

Oak did not start. He merely raised his eyes, with deliberate slowness.

Gold/Richter, for his part, had a very brief moment's delay. He had heard nothing in the ordinary sense. Something irregular had crossed the space — a presence of thought rather than a sound — and it was only afterwards that he barely managed to pinpoint its source.

They turned round.

**BGM: 'She Who Mauls' 02:41 → end**

Mewtwo was already there.

Standing in the half-light, at a polite distance from the desk, motionless. It was unclear how long he'd been there. Nor what he'd heard. Nor why he'd chosen that exact moment.

Oak looked at him for a long time. It wasn't the presence that surprised him. It was the intervention.

Gold/Richter remained even more frozen in place. His stupor was not solely due to the apparition. It also stemmed from the being itself: from that serenity devoid of warmth, that generosity devoid of animosity, that way of occupying the space without laying claim to it.

**BGM: 'She Who Mauls' 02:54 → end**

Mewtwo did not move. It said nothing more.

The air in the room seemed to grow more oppressive, though it was impossible to say where the pressure was coming from.

Oak did not reply. Neither did Gold/Richter.

They remained like that, under Mewtwo's calm, inscrutable gaze, whilst the silence stretched on until the end of the track.

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**End of episode**

## **Close of episode**

### **Totals**

≈ 13,500 words · 39 pp. A4 · read aloud ≈ 90 min.

### **Pass 1/3 — still open**

Double headers. indulgent. Point after shadow. ethical. inferred. Title if + imperfect.

Comment on demons: perception or sheet. Notes moved here. P1: background → antecedents; untouched → virgin soil; Foreign Land → Foreign Homeland; journey through → bearing toward; curse → imprecation (×4); passable → ordinary; Sword Dance → Swords Dance; Garchomp/Metagross pronouns; Seadra she/her; Mewtwo he to freeze.

### **Version notes**

2026-09-24 — EN-GB apparatus after P1. Cénacle indexed. Traces = address. Mewtwo off-screen, then present. Author filled. Title: God's Cruel Wisdom. Just a Myth kept in English. Softening and white spectre paid forward from Episodes 09–10.

### **Open for what follows**

Oak's favour · Mewtwo · Red · the Coyote still in Johto.

### **BGM credits**

Pieces: Castlevania: Nocturne (Netflix), Trevor Morris & Trey Toy. Just a Myth: listed in the OST, not used as underscoring here. Traces: duration only.